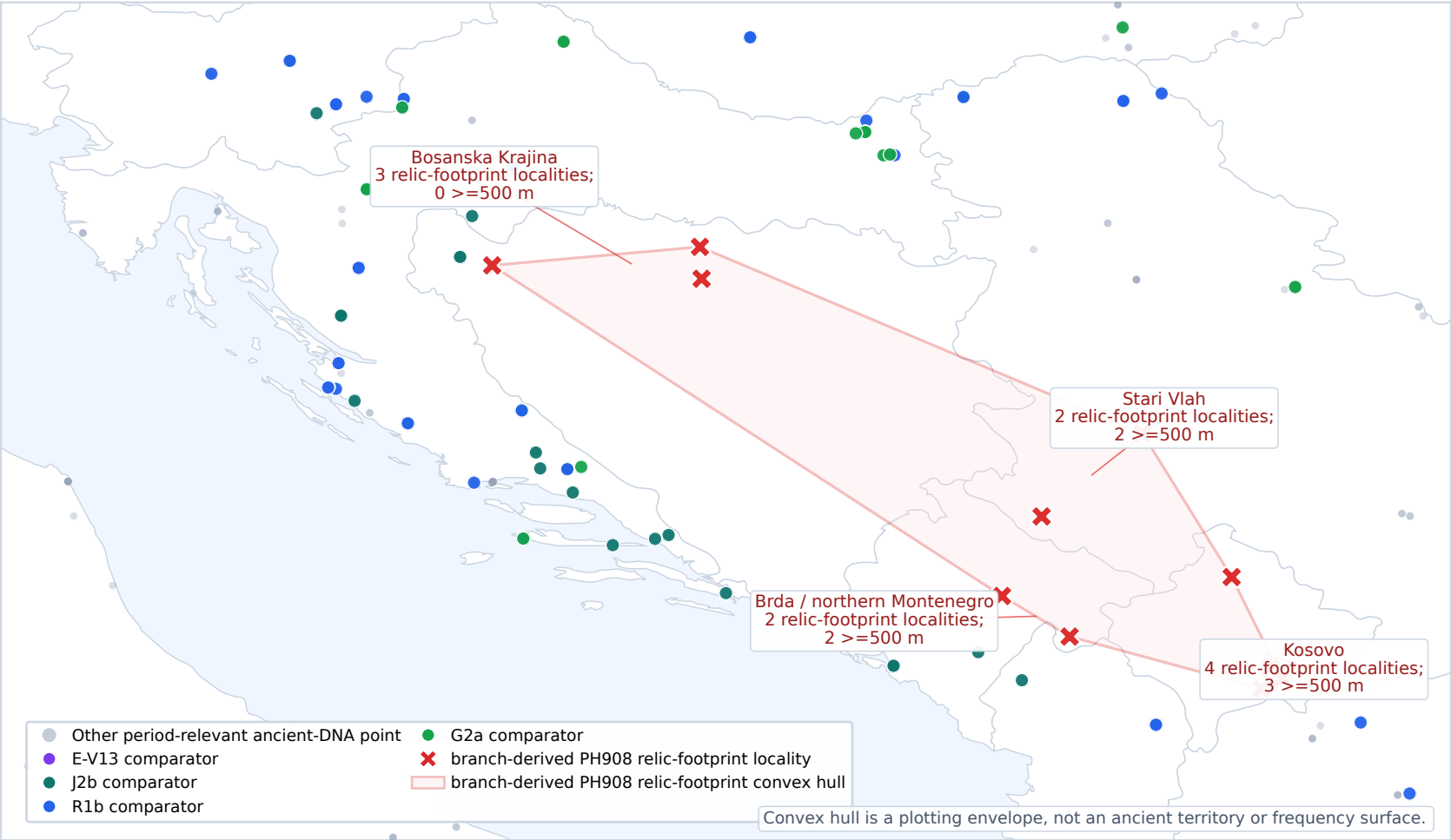


Currently published pre-550 CE ancient-DNA sampling does not yet provide strict direct negative controls for branch-derived PH908 relic-footprint localities

The map plots period-relevant ancient-DNA points retained in the curated comparison layer, visible E-V13/J2b/R1b/G2a comparators, and the branch-derived PH908 relic-footprint locality layer used for Supplementary Figure S1.



Direct negative-control eligibility

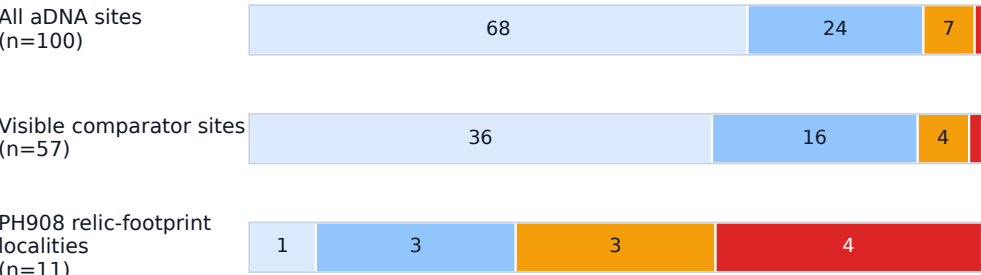
Each nearest proxy is contextual unless distance, elevation, and sampling-territory criteria all pass.

Region	n localities	within 75 km	nearest identified proxy	limiting criterion
Bosanska Krajina	3	all 42 visible 15	Zavojane-Ravca, Velika Gomila J2b, 16.7 km	sampling territory
Brda / northern Montenegro	2	all 20 visible 8	Shkrel J2b, 38.8 km	elevation
Stari Vlah	2	all 0 visible 0	Doclea Bjelovine J2b, 99.0 km	distance
Kosovo	4	all 16 visible 7	Buchinci-Skopje R1b, 50.4 km	sampling territory

Result: no listed region supplies a strict direct negative control under the predefined criteria.

Elevation visibility of source layers

Unique sites/localities; counts show how much of each source layer lies in higher-elevation bands.



Highland counts: >=500 m = all 8/100, visible 5/57, PH908 7/11. >=800 m = all 1/100, visible 1/57, PH908 4/11.

Sources: numbered Supplementary Figure S1 source-data bundle in source_data/supplementary_figure_s1; country boundaries use the bundled Natural Earth admin-0 layer. Ancient-DNA points use the 2500 BCE-550 CE window and the plotted map bounds. The PH908_convex hull is a plotting envelope around the fixed 11-row branch-derived PH908 relic-footprint layer retained after parent-or-anchor age >=1400 ybp; s1_19 documents the age-gated upstream layer, Y283553 exclusion, and plotted-layer reconciliation. The layer is a modern branch-derived target for directness testing, not an ancient territory, migration route, ethnic map, frequency surface, origin claim, continuity claim, or ancient PH908 evidence. The figure tests coverage, directness, and ecological visibility only; it is not positive ancient-DNA evidence for PH908, direct negative evidence for PH908 absence, or a claim about origin, ethnic identity, continuity, or route.